

IGOR TRON

Technical Lead | Senior PHP / WordPress Engineer

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PROFILE

I'm a Technical Lead and Senior PHP/WordPress Engineer with 18+ years in web development. My background includes enterprise WordPress development at EPAM and leading an engineering team at Cointelegraph. I take projects from architecture to production, working independently or leading a team. I build reusable workflows for Codex and Claude Code to implement WordPress projects from specifications and designs.

SELECTED ENGINEERING HIGHLIGHTS

- **Technical leadership:** Led engineering teams and guided architecture for a shared WordPress platform powering dozens of related sites.
- **Enterprise scale:** Worked on a platform supporting 150+ brand sites and contributed to a separate platform managing approximately 7,000 WordPress sites.
- **AI-assisted delivery:** Reduced implementation effort for comparable WordPress projects from 10 to 2 person-days using reusable workflows for Codex and Claude Code, with specifications and designs provided upfront.
- **Production safeguards:** Implemented role/capability controls, hardened CI/CD, strict file permissions, and controlled WordPress configuration to reduce unauthorized or accidental production changes.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead WordPress Engineer | Cointelegraph

2023–2025

New York, United States / Remote

- Led task planning, architecture decisions, code reviews, mentoring, and technical debt management for an engineering team.
- Led architecture for a shared codebase, reducing duplication across related sites and making long-term maintenance more predictable.
- Improved high-traffic platform performance and reliability through query optimization, Cloudflare caching, S3 offloading, MySQL replication, and Elasticsearch/Algolia integration.
- Diagnosed production issues across PHP, MySQL, caching/CDN, search, and infrastructure, tracing root causes across system layers.
- Improved Core Web Vitals through asset bundling, critical/deferred CSS, cache tuning, and layout stabilization.
- Built reusable skills and project-specific workflows for Codex and Claude Code to automate repeatable WordPress setup and implementation work.
- Delivered automated and semi-automated import pipelines for continuously updated content.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE — CONTINUED

PHP Software Engineer | EPAM Systems

2021–2023

Moscow, Russia / Herceg-Novi, Montenegro

- Worked on a shared WordPress platform supporting 150+ brand sites from one repository, with standardized CI/CD for reusable development and consistent deployments.
- Contributed to a separate enterprise platform managing approximately 7,000 WordPress sites with individual databases and architecture designed for maintainability at scale.
- Developed custom themes, plugins, drop-ins, Gutenberg components, and REST API extensions for enterprise clients including Bacardi and Thomson Reuters.
- Refactored database queries and application logic to improve admin responsiveness and unauthenticated request processing; optimized object/page caching and Algolia search.
- Developed a custom-table WordPress extension to model new relationships between core entities, simplifying application code and reducing database operation costs.

PHP & WordPress Specialist | Independent / Freelance

2009–2021

Worldwide

- Built and launched hundreds of WordPress sites, custom themes, plugins, and integrations, from landing pages to corporate websites.
- Migrated a publishing website from Django to WordPress, modelling tens of thousands of records with custom post types, taxonomies, and custom tables.
- Migrated hundreds of LiveJournal posts and comments to WordPress, preserving content structure, discussion threads, media, and SEO where possible.
- Introduced PHPUnit and WordPress unit-test suites to catch regressions earlier and support a test-driven engineering approach.

CORE SKILLS

WordPress & PHP: PHP 7/8, custom plugins/themes/MU-plugins, Gutenberg, REST API, WP-CLI, Multisite, hooks/filters, custom tables.

Data & Search: MySQL/MariaDB, Elasticsearch, Algolia, query optimization, replication.

Delivery & Infrastructure: Composer, Docker, nginx, Git/GitFlow, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Cloudflare, Amazon S3.

Quality & Reliability: PHPUnit, WordPress unit tests, TDD, OOP/SOLID, Xdebug, profiling, Core Web Vitals, caching/CDN, production debugging, fault-tolerant architecture.

Frontend: JavaScript, HTML5, CSS/SCSS.

AI-assisted Engineering: Codex, Claude Code, reusable agent skills, project-specific workflows, implementation and review automation.

OPEN SOURCE & COMMUNITY

- Contribute to WordPress Core through Trac tickets, some resulting in implemented changes.
- Author and maintainer of open-source WordPress plugins and PHP libraries.
- Participated in WordPress community events, including speaking at WordCamp Russia.